
SYSTEM GUIDE

LP Prospect Screener

two-stage qualification pipeline

A scored, ranked engine that turns a raw Apollo contacts export into a prioritized list of prospective Limited Partners for ID8 Growth Opportunities Fund I.

FUND	TARGET	MINIMUM LP
Growth Opportunities Fund I · \$50M Series B–D	Family Offices · MFOs · RIAs (Greater LA)	\$500K commitment

Overview

The LP Screener is a two-stage pipeline that takes a raw Apollo contacts export and outputs a scored, ranked list of prospective Limited Partners for **ID8 Growth Opportunities Fund I** — a \$50M Series B–D growth-stage tech/AI venture co-invest fund with a \$500k minimum LP commitment.

Target LPs

Family Offices (FOs), Multi-Family Offices (MFOs), and Registered Investment Advisors (RIAs) with discretionary alternatives capital — specifically ultra-high-net-worth focused firms in the Greater Los Angeles area.

Excluded

VC/PE firms (GPs, not LPs), accounting firms, law firms, management consultants, insurance/annuity shops, pension/retirement specialists, operating companies, media, non-profits, and any firm that manages retail/mass-affluent clients only.

PIPELINE AT A GLANCE

Stage 1 — Pre-Filter (Python, local): four sequential gates + a contact-quality filter narrow the export to one record per qualifying firm.

Stage 2 — Perplexity Research & Scoring: live web research scores and tiers each surviving firm 0–100.

STAGE 1

Pre-Filter — *Python*

The pre-filter runs entirely locally (no API calls) and applies four sequential gates. A firm must pass **all four** to proceed to Stage 2.

1 Geography Apollo Company City

The firm's primary city must be in a defined Greater LA set:

Los Angeles · Beverly Hills · Santa Monica · Pasadena · Irvine · Newport Beach · Westlake Village · Malibu · Century City · West Hollywood · Calabasas · Sherman Oaks · Encino · Woodland Hills · Studio City · Brentwood · Marina del Rey · Culver City · El Segundo · Manhattan Beach · Hermosa Beach · Redondo Beach · Long Beach · Torrance · Glendale · Burbank · Thousand Oaks · Camarillo · Ventura · Santa Barbara

2 Industry Apollo Industry

Apollo classifies each company by industry. The gate is a two-part check:

Result	Condition
Pass	Industry is in the allowed set, or industry is blank (unknown — let name signals decide)
Block	Industry is in the blocked set
Block	Industry is present but in neither list

Allowed industries: Financial Services, Investment Management, Capital Markets, Wealth Management, Fund-Raising.

Blocked industries (immediate disqualifiers): Venture Capital & Private Equity, Accounting, Law Practice, Legal Services, Management Consulting, Online Media, Internet, Nonprofit Organization Management, Information Technology & Services, Airlines/Aviation, Security & Investigations, Staffing & Recruiting, Professional Training & Coaching, Real Estate, Entertainment, Hospital & Health Care, Health/Wellness, Insurance, Banking, Retail, Marketing & Advertising, Human Resources, and others.

3 Firm Name — Positive Signal Apollo Company Name

The firm's name must contain at least one of the following signals (regex, case-insensitive):

- wealth management / private wealth / family wealth
- wealth (as prefix or suffix of firm name)
- wealth advisors / partners / capital / group
- family office / multi-family

- investment counsel / management / advisory / advisors / partners
- asset management / capital management
- financial advisory / advisors / advisers / planning / group / partners / services
- fiduciary / registered investment / portfolio management
- RIA (as a standalone word)
- private capital / investment

This ensures every passing firm has a name that at least suggests it could be an allocator, before the negative check removes the obvious non-fits.

4 Firm Name — Negative Exclusions Apollo Company Name

If the firm's name matches any of these patterns, it is excluded regardless of passing Gates 1–3:

Category	Patterns excluded
VC / PE / Growth Equity	ventures, venture capital, private equity, growth equity, buyout, leveraged, mezzanine, distressed
Known Large GPs	Oaktree, BlackRock, Vanguard, Fidelity, Blackstone, Carlyle, KKR, Apollo Global, Leonard Green, Platinum Equity, Capital Group, TCW, PIMCO
Accounting / Legal	CPA, certified public accountant, law corporation, law offices, LLP, PLC, attorneys
Insurance / Annuity	insurance services, annuity, life insurance, financial & insurance
Pension / Retirement	pension planner, retirement specialist, pension plan, retirement income
Coaching / Education	coaching, financial literacy, financial empowerment
Media / Podcast	media, news network, podcast, broadcasting
Non-profit / Alliance	cross border alliance, community foundation, institute for
Staffing	staffing, recruiting
Business Management	business management (entertainment / celebrity focused)
Fintech / Software	fintech, SaaS, software
Lending / Mortgage	lending group, mortgage, loan

Contact Quality Filter

Apollo First Name Last Name Title

After the four name/industry gates, the system selects the **single best contact per firm**:

- Contacts with blank names are skipped.
- Contacts with the title **"LP"** or **"Limited Partner"** are skipped — they are fund investors of other funds, not decision-makers.
- Remaining contacts are ranked by title quality.

Good titles ▲

Partner, Managing Director, Founder, Co-Founder, President, CEO, CIO, Managing Partner, Head of, Principal, Vice President, Portfolio Manager, Investment Officer, Wealth Advisor, Wealth Manager, Financial Advisor.

Bad titles ▼

Administrative, Receptionist, Coordinator, HR, Recruiter, Marketing, IT, Software Developer, Engineer, Data, Compliance Officer.

RESULT

One record per firm, with the most senior available contact attached.

STAGE 2

Perplexity Research & Scoring

The pre-filtered firms are sent to the Perplexity `sonar-pro` API for live web research and scoring. This is where the real LP qualification happens.

Batching & Parallelism

- Firms are grouped into **batches of 10**.
- Up to **8 batches run in parallel** using Python `asyncio`.
- For 159 pre-filtered firms → 16 batches → 2 parallel rounds → completes in **~2–3 minutes**.
- Each batch uses ~3,000 tokens; a full run costs roughly **\$0.10–\$0.15** at sonar-pro pricing.

What Perplexity Researches Per Firm

Dimension	What it evaluates
Entity type	Is it a genuine Family Office, RIA, or MFO? (Not a VC fund, not an operating company.)
Alternatives appetite	Does it allocate to venture, private equity, or private credit? Sources: SEC Form ADV, news, Crunchbase, firm website.
Check-size capacity	Can it write \$500k+ comfortably? Inferred from AUM, client minimums, disclosed allocations.
Sector alignment	Any stated tech/AI/growth-stage interest in portfolio or published thesis?
Emerging-manager openness	Any signals it allocates to Fund I or first-time managers?

Scoring Rubric (0–100)

Dimension	Max Points	What earns points
Alts / Venture Appetite	35	Concrete evidence of VC/PE fund commitments or direct investments
Check-Size Fit (\$500k+)	20	AUM or client profile suggests capacity
Sector Alignment (Tech/AI)	20	Stated or demonstrated tech/growth interest
Type Fit (FO/RIA)	15	Genuine allocator structure, not advisory-only
Emerging-Manager Openness	10	Fund I / first-time manager history or signals

Penalties applied for: pure public-market managers, retail-only RIAs with small minimums, advisory-only shops without discretionary capital, insurance/annuity products.

Tier Assignment

Tier	Score	Action
A	≥ 60	Contact now
B	40–59	Nurture / maybe
C	< 40	Skip

Output Per Firm

Perplexity returns a structured JSON record for each firm:

Field	Description
<code>firm</code>	Company name
<code>website</code>	URL
<code>location</code>	City, State
<code>type</code>	family_office, RIA, or other
<code>score</code>	0–100 integer
<code>tier</code>	A / B / C

Field	Description
<code>alts_venture_evidence</code>	One sentence + source URL (or "none found")
<code>estimated_check_capacity</code>	Dollar range or "unknown"
<code>rationale</code>	2–3 sentences citing what was found
<code>confidence</code>	high / medium / low

The original Apollo contact (`contact_name` , `contact_title` , `contact_email`) is merged back in from the pre-filter data.

Final Output

Two CSV files are written to `~/Downloads/` :

File	Contents
<code>lp_candidates.csv</code>	All 159 pre-filtered firms with best contact — before Perplexity
<code>lp_candidates_scored.csv</code>	All 159 firms scored + ranked by score descending, with full contact info

The scored file is sorted highest-to-lowest score. Typical yield from a 373-firm Apollo export: **~6 A-tier + ~27 B-tier = ~33 actionable prospects.**

Running the Screener

```
# Set your Perplexity API key
export PERPLEXITY_API_KEY="pplx-..."

# Run against any Apollo contacts export
python3 lp_screener_hybrid.py /path/to/apollo-contacts-export.csv
```

The script prints the full pre-filtered list for a sanity check before calling the API, so you can abort early if the filter looks off.

END-TO-END FLOW

Apollo export → Gate 1 Geography → Gate 2 Industry → Gate 3 Positive name signal → Gate 4 Negative exclusions → Contact quality filter → `lp_candidates.csv` → Perplexity research & scoring → tiering → `lp_candidates_scored.csv` .